

operators in the country to ensure that all the towers comply with the norms.

What are the various challenges that service providers in India face in managing the radiation level?

One is that the numbers of towers are way too many, so practically managing 400,000 towers is a mammoth task. It might take up to five years to practically check all of them. Currently, it's more of a compliance-mode rather than a corrective-mode. I believe that next thing that DoT will do is to reduce that level of 9.2, to say, three to keep a check.

There are various domestic and international brands available in the T&M space. What are the parameters on which a buyer makes a purchase decision.

Talking with respect to checking electromagnetic radiations, DoT has its specifications, and there are three-four vendors who comply with them. There are instruments which are used in the world but they may not fulfil the DoT's requirements. DoT says that no human interference should be there while testing, since some magnetic radiations are present in the human body itself which

can cause error. Body works like an antenna; it takes the radiation and passes it to the instrument. So telcoms and agencies follow the DoT guidelines while making a good purchase decision.

Then there are brands you are familiar with; if you are getting an instrument of some brand for the same price as Agilent's, which is a very famous and reliable brand, then you will definitely not go for it.

Engineering service companies prefer to buy domestic brands or international brands for conducting these tests?

Usually its international brands they prefer because different customers may have different perception. These companies usually would like to buy one of the best things available in the market, so they can serve all kind of customers.

Does India not manufacture high-end products?

Lot of things have started. Two years back we had to import the whole equipment. Now we manufacture lot of things in India except high-sensitivity spectrum analyser, which we import from the US. ●

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